All varieties of idealism are challenged by the fact that, aside from the contentious exception of quantum measurement, the real world seems to move along quite well without any particular help from conscious minds. Our minds discover things about the world through the process of observation and experiment, and different minds end up discovering aspects of the world that always end up being wholly consistent with one another. We have assembled quite a detailed and successful account of the first few minutes of the history of the universe, a time when there were no known minds around to think about it. Meanwhile, progress in neuroscience has increasingly been able to identify particular thought processes with specific biochemical events taking place in the material that makes up our brains. If it weren't for quantum mechanics and the measurement problem, all of our experience of reality would speak to the wisdom of putting matter first and mind emergent from it, rather than the other way around.

So, is the weirdness of the quantum measurement process sufficiently intractable that we should discard physicalism itself, in favor of an idealistic philosophy that takes mind as the primary ground of reality? Does quantum mechanics necessarily imply the centrality of the mental?

No. We don't *need* to invoke any special role for consciousness in order to address the quantum measurement problem. We've seen several counterexamples. Many-Worlds is an explicit example, accounting for the apparent collapse of the wave function using the purely mechanistic process of decoherence and branching. We're allowed to contemplate the possibility that consciousness is somehow involved, but it's just as certainly not forced on us by anything we currently understand. Of course, we will often talk about conscious experiences in our attempts to map the quantum formalism onto the world as we see it, but only when the things we're trying to explain are those experiences themselves. Otherwise, minds have nothing to do with it.

These are difficult, subtle issues, and this isn't the place for a completely fair and comprehensive adjudication of the debate between idealism and physicalism. Idealism isn't something that's easy to disprove; if someone is convinced it's right, it's hard to point to anything that would obviously change their mind (or Mind). But what they can't do is claim that quantum mechanics forces us into such a position. We have very straightforward and compelling models of the world in which reality exists